OPEN LETTER · EYE ON SHOALHAVEN COUNCIL

Letter to Cr Casmiri challenges claims behind Shoalhaven modular housing panel

Sent 10 October 2026 · To Cr Casmiri · Response requested by 16 October 2026

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10 October 2026
Cr Luciano Casmiri
Shoalhaven City Council
By email: [

Dear Cr Casmiri,

Re: "The Future of Prefabrication & Modular Homes in Shoalhaven" – questions and request for corrections

I am writing about a post circulated under the SIG banner proposing a "Prefabrication and Modular Panel" that would include "local developers and construction stakeholders" to establish design guidelines "in concert with our LEP and DCP". A copy is attached. You are the councillor most closely associated with the housing and development agenda the post advances, including your manufactured-homes motion, so I am putting these questions to you directly.

The post makes claims it does not support, and leaves out information a resident would need to judge the proposal. I am giving you the opportunity to correct it, to supply what it omits, and to answer the questions below.

Authorship
1. Did you write, approve or endorse this post? If not you, who authored it, on whose authority was it published, and on what date and platform?

The claims in the post
2. The post says the market is "projected to reach 17.1 billion by 2034". It gives no currency and no source. The figure matches a US-dollar forecast from a commercial market-research firm. Other published forecasts are far lower, including A$7.7 billion by 2030 and US$5.5 billion by 2031. What is the source and currency of your figure, and why were the lower forecasts not mentioned?

1. **The post says "Government is making significant investment". Which programs do you mean, and how much of that funding is directed specifically to prefabricated**

and modular housing, as distinct from general housing programs? The only modular-specific commitment I have found is about $54 million.

1. The post says Shoalhaven has an "absence of a Shoalhaven Style Guide". What do you mean by that? Which existing provisions of the Development Control Plan did you consider, and why are they inadequate for manufactured and modular dwellings?

1. The post says modular homes are an urgent matter for Shoalhaven. Council is already assessing manufactured-home applications, including at Bawley Point, Callala Bay, Bomaderry and Nowra. What gap in the current planning pathway makes this urgent?

The proposed panel

6. Is a notice of motion or other formal proposal being prepared? If so, when will it be lodged, and by whom?

1. Who would appoint the panel? How many of its members would be developers or people who build or sell modular homes? Would it meet in public, publish its agendas and minutes, and require members to declare interests?

1. How would the panel's guidelines acquire any status under the LEP and DCP? How would they be exhibited for public comment, and what role would residents, the community and Council's own planners have in writing them?

1. In December 2024 you moved to rescind the local character statements, citing cost and delay and the need for input from all stakeholders. How is a panel that includes developers consistent with the community input those statements were built on?

Costs and standards

10. Cr Wilkins has sought a pause on land lease approvals until the load on water, sewer, roads, and fire and flood protection is measured. Do you support measuring infrastructure and lifecycle costs, including those of new greenfield sites and land lease communities, before further approvals? Who, in your view, should bear those costs?

1. What is your position on reducing housing design or building standards to lower costs? If you support it, what evidence do you have that the saving would reach buyers or renters rather than the developer's margin, and what mechanisms (covenants, price controls, affordability requirements) would ensure that?

1. What does your manufactured-homes motion propose, and what does it say about rates, infrastructure contributions and the effect on Council's long-term maintenance liabilities?

Interests

13. Do you hold any pecuniary or non-pecuniary interest in, or any association with, a

business in the prefabrication, modular, manufactured-home or land lease sectors, or with any applicant before Council in those sectors, and have you declared it?

Please reply in writing by 5:00 pm on Friday 16 October 2026. Where you rely on a document, a motion, a business paper item or a minute, please give me the reference so I can check it.

Your response, or the absence of one, will be recorded accurately.

Yours sincerely,

Steve Prothero
Eye on Shoalhaven Council
Attachment: copy of the post "The Future of Prefabrication & Modular Homes in Shoalhaven"
